

MOCK 12 IIMK BMS AT: VERBAL ABILITY

Q1: What is the meaning of "insipid"?

- A) Rich and flavourful
- B) Bold and daring
- C) Dull, lacking spirit or flavour
- D) Fresh and invigorating

Correct Answer: C) Dull, lacking spirit or flavour

Explanation: "Insidip" describes something that is bland, boring, or lacking any real character or taste.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) This is nearly the opposite, insipid means lacking flavour, not having rich taste.
- B) Bold and daring suggests strong character or courage, which is the opposite of something dull and lifeless.
- D) Fresh and invigorating implies energy and liveliness, which contradicts the flat, dull sense of insipid.

Q2: What does "truculent" mean?

- A) Calm and agreeable
- B) Aggressively hostile and defiant
- C) Shy and withdrawn
- D) Generous and kind

Correct Answer: B) Aggressively hostile and defiant

Explanation: "Truculent" describes someone who is fierce, quick to argue, or eager to fight.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) This is the opposite, truculent people are argumentative and hostile, not calm or easygoing.
- C) Being shy or withdrawn means avoiding conflict, while truculent behavior actively seeks confrontation.
- D) Generosity and kindness have no connection to the hostile, combative nature this word describes.

Q3: What does the word "abrogate" mean?

- A) To officially cancel or revoke
- B) To strengthen and reinforce
- C) To celebrate publicly
- D) To ignore quietly

Correct Answer: A) To officially cancel or revoke

Explanation: "Abrogate" means to formally do away with a law, agreement, or right.

Why the other options are wrong:

B) This is the opposite, abrogating something ends it, rather than making it stronger.

C) Celebrating publicly has nothing to do with formally cancelling something.

D) Ignoring something quietly is passive, while abrogating is an active, official act of cancellation.

Q4: Choose the most appropriate meaning/phrasal verb/word/verb for the sentence.

The old sailor always went by the book when repairing the ship's engine.

A) Followed rules and procedures strictly

B) Fixed things using guesswork

C) Ignored the instructions completely

D) Asked others to do the repairs

Correct Answer: A) Followed rules and procedures strictly

Explanation: "Go by the book" means to do something exactly according to the rules or official instructions, without deviating.

Why the other options are wrong:

B) Guesswork is the opposite of following a strict method or rulebook.

C) Ignoring instructions is the direct opposite of what this idiom means.

D) Asking others to do the work has nothing to do with following procedures yourself.

Q5: Choose the most appropriate meaning/phrasal verb/word/verb for the sentence.

The journalist decided to blow the whistle on the company's illegal practices.

A) Celebrate the company's success

B) Expose wrongdoing to the public

C) Ignore the illegal practices quietly

D) Ask for a promotion

Correct Answer: B) Expose wrongdoing to the public

Explanation: "Blow the whistle" means to report or reveal illegal or unethical activity, usually to authorities or the public.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) Celebrating success has no connection to exposing wrongdoing, which is the actual meaning here.

C) Ignoring the practices quietly is the opposite of what blowing the whistle means.

D) Asking for a promotion is unrelated to reporting illegal activity.

Q6: Choose the most appropriate meaning/phrasal verb/word/verb for the sentence.

She always plays devil's advocate during team discussions.

A) Argues a different side just to spark debate

B) Agrees with everyone immediately

C) Stays silent during discussions

D) Praises every idea proposed

Correct Answer: A) Argues a different side just to spark debate

Explanation: "Play devil's advocate" means to argue the opposite side of a discussion, not because you believe it, but to test the strength of an idea or spark deeper thinking.

Why the other options are wrong:

B) Agreeing with everyone is the opposite of challenging ideas, which is what this idiom is about.

C) Staying silent contradicts the idea of actively arguing a counterpoint.

D) Praising every idea is the opposite of questioning or challenging them, which is the core of this idiom.

Q7: Choose the most appropriate meaning/phrasal verb/word/verb for the sentence.

The new manager's proposal to restructure the entire department turned out to be a Pandora's box of problems.

A) A source of unexpected wealth

B) A source of many unforeseen troubles

C) A quick and easy solution

D) A well kept secret

Correct Answer: B) A source of many unforeseen troubles

Explanation: "Pandora's box" refers to something that looks harmless at first but ends up causing a lot of unexpected problems once it's opened or started.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) The idiom is about trouble, not wealth, so this doesn't match at all.

C) It's the opposite really, a Pandora's box creates complications, not easy fixes.

D) Nothing about the idiom implies secrecy, it's about consequences becoming visible, not hidden.

Q8: Choose the most appropriate meaning/phrasal verb/word/verb for the sentence.

He was clearly a fish out of water at the formal dinner, unsure which fork to use.

- A) Extremely confident and at ease
- B) Uncomfortable in an unfamiliar situation
- C) Angry about being invited
- D) Skilled at social situations

Correct Answer: B) Uncomfortable in an unfamiliar situation

Explanation: "A fish out of water" describes someone who feels awkward or out of place because they're in a situation they're not used to.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) This is the opposite, the idiom describes discomfort, not confidence.
- C) The idiom has nothing to do with anger, it's about feeling out of place.
- D) Being skilled at social situations contradicts the idea of being awkward and unfamiliar with the setting.

Q9: Choose the most appropriate meaning/phrasal verb/word/verb for the sentence.

Rather than admit the project had failed, the team decided to move the goalposts and redefine what success meant.

- A) Change the rules to match a new outcome
- B) Give up on the project entirely
- C) Ask for outside help
- D) Celebrate a genuine achievement

Correct Answer: A) Change the rules to match a new outcome

Explanation: "Move the goalposts" means to unfairly change the standards or rules of a situation, usually after the fact, so it seems easier to succeed.

Why the other options are wrong:

- B) Giving up is the opposite, this idiom is about avoiding failure by changing definitions, not walking away.
- C) Asking for help has nothing to do with redefining terms or standards.
- D) A genuine achievement wouldn't require changing the rules, this idiom specifically implies dishonesty about the outcome.

Q10: Choose the most appropriate meaning/phrasal verb/word/verb for the sentence.

Instead of addressing the budget crisis directly, the finance minister chose to kick the can down the road for another fiscal year.

- A) Solve the crisis immediately
- B) Blame previous officials for the crisis
- C) Delay dealing with a problem instead of resolving it
- D) Announce a public apology

Correct Answer: C) Delay dealing with a problem instead of resolving it

Explanation: "Kick the can down the road" means to postpone a decision or problem instead of dealing with it now, usually leaving it worse for later.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) This is the direct opposite, the idiom is specifically about avoiding an immediate solution.
- B) Blaming others isn't part of this idiom, it's purely about delay, not deflecting responsibility.
- D) An apology has nothing to do with postponing action, which is the actual meaning here.

Q11: Choose the most appropriate meaning/phrasal verb/word/verb for the sentence.

After the missed deadlines piled up, the supervisor finally read the riot act to the entire team.

- A) Gave a firm and stern warning
- B) Congratulated them for their effort
- C) Assigned them additional paid leave
- D) Quietly ignored their mistakes

Correct Answer: A) Gave a firm and stern warning

Explanation: "Read the riot act" means to scold or warn someone very seriously and firmly, usually about their behaviour needing to change immediately.

Why the other options are wrong:

- B) Congratulating is the opposite tone, this idiom is about strict scolding, not praise.
- C) The idiom has nothing to do with rewards like leave, it's specifically about a stern reprimand.
- D) Ignoring mistakes contradicts the idiom entirely, since reading the riot act means directly confronting the issue.

Q12: Fill in the blank with the most appropriate word/phrase.

Despite the tabloid's constant provocations, the actress managed to _____ any public reaction that could fuel further rumours.

- A) Give way to
- B) Fall prey to
- C) Come around to
- D) Keep at bay

Correct Answer: D) Keep at bay

Explanation: "Keep at bay" means to stop something from getting close or having an effect, which fits since she avoided reacting despite the provocation.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) "Give way to" means to let something happen or take over, which is the opposite of resisting a reaction.

B) "Fall prey to" means to be negatively affected or tricked by something, which again means she gave in, not resisted.

C) "Come around to" means to eventually agree with or accept something, which doesn't fit the idea of resisting a reaction at all.

Q13: Fill in the blank with the most appropriate word/phrase.

Against all odds, the small startup managed to _____ a partnership with the industry giant, leaving competitors baffled.

- A) Clinch
- B) Broker
- C) Draft
- D) Negotiate

Correct Answer: A) Clinch

Explanation: "Clinch" means to successfully finalize or secure something after effort, especially something that seemed difficult or uncertain, which fits the surprise element in the sentence.

Why the other options are wrong:

B) "Broker" means to arrange or mediate a deal between two other parties, but here the startup itself is one of the parties involved, not a middleman.

C) "Draft" means to prepare an early written version of something, like an agreement, not to actually complete or secure it.

D) "Negotiate" refers to the ongoing discussion process itself, not the final successful outcome the sentence describes.

Q14: Choose the word that best fits the blank.

It was his _____, spending lavishly on things he neither needed nor could afford, that eventually left him with nothing.

- A) Insolence
- B) Profligacy
- C) Impudence
- D) Audacity

Correct Answer: B) Profligacy

Explanation: "Profligacy" specifically means being recklessly wasteful with money, which directly matches the description of spending lavishly on unnecessary and unaffordable things.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) "Insolence" means being disrespectful or rude, which has no connection to financial habits or spending.

C) "Impudence" also relates to being bold and disrespectful in behaviour or speech, not to wasting money.

D) "Audacity" means bold or shocking daring, which could describe risky behaviour but doesn't specifically mean wasteful spending.

Q15: Choose the word that best completes the sentence.

With hands trembling from nerves, he _____ the last of the whiskey before walking into the interrogation room.

A) Decanted

B) Siphoned

C) Downed

D) Dispensed

Correct Answer: C) Downed

Explanation: "Downed" specifically means to drink something completely and quickly, which fits the tense, hurried mood of the sentence before facing something stressful.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) "Decanted" means pouring liquid carefully from one container to another, often to separate sediment, which doesn't capture the urgency of drinking here.

B) "Siphoned" means to draw liquid out using a tube through suction, which is a technical action unrelated to drinking from a glass.

D) "Dispensed" means to give out or distribute something, which doesn't fit the personal act of drinking described in the sentence.

Q16: Choose the option that correctly completes the sentence.

Had the negotiators not intervened at the eleventh hour, the entire ceasefire _____ apart within days.

A) will fall

B) would fall

C) would have fallen

D) had fallen

Correct Answer: C) would have fallen

Explanation: This is a third conditional sentence about something that did not happen in the past, so it needs "would have fallen" to match "had the negotiators not intervened."

Why the other options are wrong:

A) "Will fall" is future tense and doesn't fit a sentence describing an imagined past outcome.

B) "Would fall" is used for present or future unreal situations, not for something already resolved in the past.

D) "Had fallen" is only past perfect and lacks the "would have" needed to show the imagined consequence.

Q17: Choose the option that correctly completes the sentence.

He carries himself as though he _____ the entire expedition single handedly, though records show three other explorers led the way.

- A) will have led
- B) leads
- C) would lead
- D) had led

Correct Answer: D) had led

Explanation: After "as though" describing something false about the past, we use past perfect, so "had led" fits since he is falsely claiming credit for leading the expedition alone.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) "Will have led" is future perfect and cannot describe a false claim about something already completed in the past.

B) "Leads" is present tense, which doesn't convey the unreal or exaggerated nature of a past claim.

C) "Would lead" suggests a hypothetical future action, not something falsely claimed as already finished.

Q18: In the following sentence, the incorrect part is underlined. Choose an alternative from the four given options so that the sentence is rendered correct.

If the auditors would have caught the discrepancy sooner, the fraud might never have escalated to this scale.

- A) caught
- B) would catch
- C) had caught
- D) have caught

Correct Answer: C) had caught

Explanation: This is a mixed conditional sentence where the "if" clause needs to be in past perfect, "had caught," to correctly pair with "might never have escalated" describing the unreal past outcome.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) "Caught" alone is simple past and can't properly set up the conditional structure needed with "might have escalated."

B) "Would catch" incorrectly uses "would" in the if clause itself, which is a common error since both clauses can't have "would" type structures together.

D) "Have caught" is missing the "had" needed to form past perfect, so it doesn't correctly show the action happening before the fraud escalated.

Q19: The sentences below have words that are missing. Choose the best option from those given below to complete the sentence.

The advent of deep-sea submersibles allowed scientists to begin surveying the ocean floor and the many _____ that lie within it, to catalogue the numerous organisms and _____ that are better studied through direct observation. All of these undertakings, cataloguing, hypothesis testing, and the _____ of findings to inform conservation policy, are elements of marine _____.

A) trenches; taxonomies; dissemination; biogeography

B) abyss; phenomena; assimilation; exploration

C) chasms; ecosystems; codification; taxonomy

D) crevices; organisms; propagation; oceanography

Correct Answer: A) trenches; taxonomies; dissemination; biogeography

Explanation: "Trenches" fits since deep-sea submersibles specifically survey ocean trenches, "taxonomies" matches the classification of organisms being catalogued, "dissemination" fits spreading findings to inform policy, and "biogeography" correctly names the field studying distribution of organisms across environments.

Why the other options are wrong:

B) "Assimilation" means absorbing or incorporating something into a whole, which doesn't fit sharing findings with policymakers, and "exploration" is too vague compared to the specific field named in the passage.

C) "Codification" refers to organizing laws or rules into a system, not to spreading scientific data for conservation use.

D) "Propagation" typically refers to breeding or spreading organisms themselves, not spreading knowledge or findings to others.

Q20: The sentences below have words that are missing. Choose the best option from those given below to complete the sentence.

Technically ambitious, _____ films of the 1930s are seldom _____ archived and often succumb to nitrate decay, leading to the _____ that early sound cinema was rudimentary and unrefined.

A) sepia; meticulously; conjecture

B) monochrome; adequately; misapprehension

- C) grainy; sporadically; presumption
- D) archaic; consistently; fallacy

Correct Answer: B) monochrome; adequately; misapprehension

Explanation: "Monochrome" accurately describes black and white films from the 1930s, "adequately" fits the idea that preservation efforts fall short, and "misapprehension" precisely means a mistaken belief, matching the false idea that early films were unrefined.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) "Conjecture" means a guess based on incomplete information, which is weaker than the definite false belief the passage describes.
- C) "Grainy" describes texture rather than colour format, and "presumption" implies an assumption taken for granted rather than a specifically incorrect belief.
- D) "Archaic" simply means old fashioned, which doesn't specifically describe the film format itself, and "fallacy" refers to a logical error rather than a general misconception.

Q21: The sentences below have words that are missing. Choose the best option from those given below to complete the sentence.

Every day, countless promotional messages are dispatched that are commercial and _____. Although _____ have deployed increasingly sophisticated countermeasures to curb this influx, _____ persistently circumvent these safeguards.

- A) superfluous; conglomerates; charlatans
- B) unwarranted; watchdogs; profiteers
- C) unsolicited; regulators; spammers
- D) gratuitous; custodians; racketeers

Correct Answer: C) unsolicited; regulators; spammers

Explanation: "Unsolicited" precisely describes unwanted promotional messages sent without request, "regulators" fits bodies that create countermeasures against such messages, and "spammers" correctly names those who send the unwanted messages and evade restrictions.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) "Conglomerates" refers to large business groups, which doesn't specifically match those deploying anti-spam measures, and "charlatans" implies fraud rather than simply circumventing filters.
- B) "Watchdogs" is close in meaning but less precise than "regulators" in this formal context, and "profiteers" implies exploiting a situation for profit rather than specifically sending spam.
- D) "Custodians" implies protection or guardianship in a general sense, not specifically regulatory bodies, and "racketeers" implies organized crime rather than the more fitting term for those sending unsolicited messages.

Q22: The sentences below have words that are missing. Choose the best option from those given below to complete the sentence.

The allure of _____ lies in its capacity to unravel questions we rarely confront about consciousness and existence _____. Moreover, _____ upon paradigms proposed by eminent thinkers across centuries can furnish us with a sharper _____ of our own place in the universe.

- A) theology; broadly; deliberating; conviction
- B) epistemology; superficially; ruminating; clarity
- C) metaphysics; itself; contemplating; perspective
- D) cosmology; entirely; speculating; certainty

Correct Answer: C) metaphysics; itself; contemplating; perspective

Explanation: "Metaphysics" precisely covers questions about consciousness and existence, "itself" fits grammatically after existence, "contemplating" means thinking deeply, matching the reflective tone, and "perspective" fits as the natural outcome of that reflection.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) "Theology" narrows the scope only to religious study, which doesn't match questions about existence in a broader philosophical sense, and "conviction" implies certainty rather than an evolving understanding.
- B) "Superficially" contradicts the entire idea of unravelling deep questions, since the passage is clearly about deep, not shallow, engagement with ideas.
- D) "Speculating" is close but "certainty" contradicts the humble, ongoing nature of gaining perspective, since certainty implies a fixed, final conclusion rather than growing understanding.

Q23: In the following sentence, the incorrect part is underlined. Choose an alternative from the four given options so that the sentence is rendered correct.

His lecture on ancient civilisations has picked up considerable curiosity among the students.

- A) fostered
- B) elicited
- C) engendered
- D) piqued

Correct Answer: D) piqued

Explanation: "Piqued curiosity" is a fixed, natural phrase meaning to stimulate someone's interest or curiosity, which fits perfectly with "picked up" being incorrect here.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) "Fostered" typically pairs with nurturing something over time, like fostering growth or talent, not with sudden curiosity from a single lecture.
- B) "Elicited" usually pairs with a response or reaction, like eliciting a comment, and sounds unnatural directly before "curiosity" in this context.

C) "Engendered" means to give rise to something, and while grammatically possible, it's far less natural and idiomatic here than "piqued," which is the standard collocation with curiosity.

Q24: In the following sentence, the incorrect part is underlined. Choose an alternative from the four given options so that the sentence is rendered correct.

Had the surgeon not intervened within minutes, the patient will have succumbed to the internal bleeding.

- A) would succumb
- B) had succumbed
- C) was succumbing
- D) would have succumbed

Correct Answer: D) would have succumbed

Explanation: The sentence begins with "Had the surgeon not intervened," a third conditional structure about an imagined past, so the result needs "would have succumbed" to correctly match.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) "Would succumb" is used for present or future unreal situations, not for something imagined about the past like this sentence.
- B) "Had succumbed" is only past perfect on its own and lacks the "would have" needed to show the imagined outcome.
- C) "Was succumbing" is past continuous and only describes an ongoing action, it doesn't fit the conditional structure being tested here.

Q25: Each sentence among the questions has pairs of words that are italicized. Among the italicized words, select the most appropriate word to form a correct sentence.

- A. The old librarian moved through the archive, *sorting [A] / sordid [B]* through decades of forgotten letters.
- B. As the storm *dispersed [A] / disbursed [B]* over the valley, the villagers finally emerged from their homes.
- C. The manuscript, written in a *cursive [A] / cursory [B]* hand, was nearly impossible to decipher.
- D. With cautious steps, Meera entered the abandoned house, *apprehensive [A] / comprehensive [B]* of what she might find inside.
- E. For decades, the townsfolk believed the fire that *ravaged [A] / ravished [B]* the old mill was deliberate.

- A) AAABA
- B) AAAAA
- C) BABAA
- D) AABAB

Correct Answer: B) AAAAA

Explanation: "Sorting" fits since it means going through things methodically, while "sordid" means dirty or immoral, which doesn't fit. "Dispersed" means scattered or cleared away, matching the storm passing. "Cursive" refers to joined up handwriting, which fits describing difficult to read writing. "Apprehensive" means nervous or anxious, matching her cautious entry. "Ravaged" means violently destroyed, fitting a fire damaging a mill.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) This starts with "sorting" correctly but then uses "disbursed," which means paying out money, not clearing away like a storm.

C) This begins with "sordid," meaning dirty or immoral, which makes no sense with going through old letters methodically.

D) This ends with "ravished," which means to overwhelm with delight or to assault, neither of which fits a fire damaging a building.

Q26: Each sentence among the questions has pairs of words that are italicized and bold. Among the italicized and bold words, select the most appropriate word to form a correct sentence.

A. She *clasped* [A] / *grasped* [B] the railing tightly as the ship lurched in the storm.

B. Her uncle had always *deterred* [A] / *detained* [B] her from wandering into the old orchard alone.

C. The floorboards *groaned* [A] / *grieved* [B] under the weight of the heavy trunk being dragged across.

D. The window *shattered* [A] / *scattered* [B] into a hundred pieces when the branch struck it.

E. Determination, *fiercer* [A] / *fierier* [B] than any doubt, pushed her to finish the climb.

A) AAAAA

B) BABAB

C) ABABA

D) AAAAB

Correct Answer: A) AAAAA

Explanation: "Clasped" means held firmly, which fits gripping a railing during a storm. "Deterred" means discouraged someone from doing something, matching the uncle stopping her from wandering off. "Groaned" fits floorboards making a low creaking sound under weight. "Shattered" means broken into many pieces, matching the window breaking. "Fiercer" is the correct comparative form of fierce, matching determination being stronger than doubt.

Why the other options are wrong:

B) This uses "detained," which means held back by force or law, not the gentler sense of discouraging someone from an action.

C) This uses "grieved" for the floorboards, but grieving means feeling sorrow, which doesn't apply to boards creaking under weight.

D) This ends with "fierier," which isn't even a standard comparative form in English, "fiercer" is the correct word.

Q27: Can you identify the grammatically incorrect sentence from each set?

- A) He behaves as though he owns the entire building, though he merely rents a single room.
- B) The board insisted that the report be submitted by Monday without fail.
- C) She wishes she was fluent in three languages instead of just one.
- D) By the time the ambulance arrived, the patient had already regained consciousness.

Correct Answer: C) She wishes she was fluent in three languages instead of just one.

Explanation: When expressing a wish about something untrue in the present, we use "were" instead of "was," so the correct form is "she wishes she were fluent."

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) This sentence is correct because "as though he owns" is describing a habitual manner of behaving, which can take present tense here.
- B) This sentence is correct because after "insisted," we use the base form of the verb, so "be submitted" without "is" is right.
- D) This sentence is correct because "had already regained" properly shows the patient's action happened before the ambulance arrived, using past perfect correctly.

Q28: Can you identify the grammatically incorrect sentence from each set?

- A) If she had left earlier, she wouldn't have missed the flight.
- B) He acts as if he were the only one capable of the job.
- C) I wish I had known about the meeting beforehand.
- D) She talks as though she has visited the palace, when she never actually did.

Correct Answer: D) She talks as though she has visited the palace, when she never actually did.

Explanation: Since she never actually visited, this is a false claim about the past, so it needs "had visited" instead of "has visited."

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) This is correct because it properly uses "had left" and "wouldn't have missed" together for an unreal past condition.
- B) This is correct because "as if" with something untrue in the present correctly takes "were" instead of "was."
- C) This is correct because "wish" followed by "had known" properly expresses regret about something in the past.

Q29: Can you identify the grammatically incorrect sentence from each set?

- A) The judge ordered that the documents be sealed immediately.
- B) He would rather she left tonight than tomorrow.

- C) She told me that she would call once she landed.
- D) If only he has apologised sooner, things wouldn't have escalated.

Correct Answer: D) If only he has apologised sooner, things wouldn't have escalated.

Explanation: Since this expresses regret about something in the past, it needs "had apologised" instead of "has apologised."

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) This is correct because after "ordered," the base form "be sealed" is the proper subjunctive structure.
- B) This is correct because "would rather" followed by past tense like "left" is the standard way to express a preference.
- C) This is correct because reported speech naturally uses "would" to describe a future action from the past.

Q30: Can you identify the grammatically incorrect sentence from each set?

- A) The train departs at 9, so we should leave by 7.
- B) He had been renovating the house since three years.
- C) No sooner had she locked the door than the phone rang.
- D) By next year, they will have been colleagues for a decade.

Correct Answer: B) He had been renovating the house since three years.

Explanation: For a length of time like "three years," we use "for," not "since," which is only used with a specific point in time.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) This is correct because present simple can describe a fixed schedule even when referring to something happening soon.
- C) This is correct because "no sooner had... than" is the right structure for one event following immediately after another in the past.
- D) This is correct because "will have been" properly shows a continuing state up to a point in the future.

Q31: Identify the appropriate conclusion based on the premises.

Premise 1: All published astrophysicists have peer reviewed papers.

Premise 2: Some peer reviewed papers are not written by astrophysicists.

Conclusion:

- A) All peer reviewed papers are written by astrophysicists.
- B) No astrophysicist lacks peer reviewed papers.
- C) Some peer reviewed papers may belong to non astrophysicists.
- D) No peer reviewed paper is written by an astrophysicist.

Correct Answer: C) Some peer reviewed papers may belong to non astrophysicists.

Explanation: Premise 2 already tells us some peer reviewed papers aren't written by astrophysicists, so it logically follows that some of these papers may belong to people who aren't astrophysicists at all.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) This is too strong a claim, premise 2 directly contradicts this by stating some papers aren't written by astrophysicists.

B) While technically restating part of premise 1, it doesn't use the information from premise 2 at all, making it an incomplete conclusion.

D) This directly contradicts premise 1, which clearly states astrophysicists do have peer reviewed papers.

Q32: Identify the appropriate conclusion based on the premises.

Premise 1: If an alloy is exposed to moisture, it corrodes.

Premise 2: This alloy did not corrode.

Conclusion:

A) The alloy was exposed to moisture.

B) All alloys corrode eventually.

C) The alloy was not exposed to moisture.

D) The alloy is naturally rust resistant.

Correct Answer: C) The alloy was not exposed to moisture.

Explanation: Since exposure to moisture always leads to corrosion, and this alloy did not corrode, it logically means it was never exposed to moisture in the first place, this follows the contrapositive of the original statement.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) This directly contradicts the given premise, if it had been exposed, it would have corroded according to premise 1.

B) This is an unsupported generalisation, the premises only talk about this specific alloy, not all alloys everywhere.

D) Nothing about rust resistance is mentioned anywhere in the premises, this brings in an assumption not stated at all.

Q33: Identify the appropriate conclusion based on the premises.

Premise 1: Only if the transmitter is calibrated will the signal reach the station.

Premise 2: The signal did not reach the station.

Conclusion:

- A) The transmitter is definitely damaged.
- B) The signal was too weak to travel.
- C) The transmitter must be uncalibrated.
- D) The station's receiver was turned off.

Correct Answer: C) The transmitter must be uncalibrated.

Explanation: Since calibration is a necessary condition for the signal reaching the station, and the signal did not reach it, this means the transmitter cannot have been calibrated, following the logical contrapositive of the premise.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) Damage is never mentioned in the premises, this introduces information that isn't given or implied anywhere.
- B) Signal strength is not discussed at all, this is an assumption that goes beyond what the premises actually state.
- D) The receiver being off is not something the premises talk about, this conclusion isn't supported by the given information.

Q34: Identify the appropriate conclusion based on the premises.

Premise 1: No cartographers are historians.

Premise 2: All surveyors are cartographers.

Conclusion:

- A) No surveyor is a historian.
- B) All surveyors are historians.
- C) Some cartographers are historians.
- D) All historians are surveyors.

Correct Answer: A) No surveyor is a historian.

Explanation: Since all surveyors fall under cartographers, and no cartographer can be a historian, it means surveyors can never be historians either.

Why the other options are wrong:

- B) This is the opposite of what the premises tell us, since cartographers and historians are completely separate groups.
- C) There is no information connecting cartographers to historians in this way, the premises clearly state they never overlap.
- D) This reverses the relationship in a way that's never mentioned, surveyors being cartographers tells us nothing about all historians being surveyors.

Reading Comprehension 1:

A cadre of manuscript conservators recently announced the recovery of nearly 1,200 previously indecipherable passages from a cache of medieval palimpsests, texts that had been scraped and overwritten centuries ago to conserve costly parchment. Employing multispectral imaging calibrated to isolate residual ink pigments imperceptible to the naked eye, the team purports to have reconstructed portions of scripture, philosophical treatises, and even fragments of lost classical works presumed to have vanished irretrievably from the historical record.

Scholars external to the project have greeted these claims with considerable circumspection, for reasons transcending mere academic rivalry. The imaging technique, while undeniably sophisticated, relies on statistical inference to bridge gaps where pigment traces are too faint to register directly, meaning a portion of every "recovered" passage is, in effect, an educated conjecture rather than a literal transcription. Compounding this, the same parchment sheets were frequently palimpsested more than once, with successive scribes scraping away not the original text but an intermediate stratum, such that imaging can inadvertently conflate ink residues from two or even three chronologically unrelated texts into a single, deceptively coherent passage.

A further complication resides in how "recovery" itself is operationally defined for this announcement. The cited figure of 1,200 passages only encompasses fragments where at least sixty percent of a sentence's characters could be assigned a confidence score exceeding a fixed statistical threshold, a threshold that fluctuates considerably depending on the parchment's antiquity, storage conditions, and prior exposure to light. Consequently, a passage housed in a monastery with stable humidity for eight centuries might clear this threshold with ease, while an equally significant fragment subjected to more volatile conditions could fall marginally short and go entirely uncounted, not because its content is any less authentic, but purely because of the vicissitudes of its custodial history.

Compounding matters further, the conservators have withheld the raw spectral data underlying their reconstructions, citing ongoing negotiations with the parchment's custodial institution. Independent palaeographers have therefore been unable to ascertain whether the confidence thresholds were applied uniformly across the entire cache, or whether passages substantiating more sensational claims, such as fragments resembling lost classical texts, were subjected to a more lenient criterion than the comparatively mundane liturgical material recovered from the same sheets.

Q35: According to the passage, why can multispectral imaging sometimes produce a "misleadingly coherent passage"?

- A) Because the parchment was too old to scan accurately
- B) Because scribes deliberately forged texts to deceive future readers
- C) Because ink residues from multiple unrelated texts on the same sheet can get combined
- D) Because the imaging equipment was not properly calibrated

Correct Answer: C) Because ink residues from multiple unrelated texts on the same sheet can get combined

Explanation: The passage explains that sheets were often palimpsested more than once, so imaging can accidentally merge ink traces from different, unrelated texts into what looks like one coherent passage.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) Age itself isn't given as the direct cause of this specific problem, the issue is about layered texts being mixed up, not scanning difficulty from age alone.
- B) The passage never mentions deliberate forgery or deception by scribes, this isn't supported anywhere in the text.
- D) Calibration issues aren't blamed for this particular problem, the passage attributes it to overlapping text layers, not equipment error.

Q36: What does the word "circumspection" most nearly mean as used in the passage?

- A) Enthusiasm
- B) Cautious skepticism
- C) Complete rejection
- D) Genuine admiration

Correct Answer: B) Cautious skepticism

Explanation: "Circumspection" means being careful and wary before accepting something, which fits how outside scholars responded to the claims with doubt rather than immediate acceptance or rejection.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) Enthusiasm implies excitement or eager support, which is the opposite of the cautious, doubtful reaction described.
- C) Complete rejection is too extreme, the passage shows scholars being doubtful and questioning, not entirely dismissing the claims outright.
- D) Genuine admiration would mean full approval, which contradicts the skeptical tone described in the passage.

Q37: Based on the passage, why might an equally significant fragment go uncounted in the recovery figures?

- A) It was intentionally excluded by the research team
- B) It failed to meet the confidence threshold due to storage conditions
- C) It contained text that was already well known to scholars
- D) It was written in a language the imaging couldn't process

Correct Answer: B) It failed to meet the confidence threshold due to storage conditions

Explanation: The passage explains that a fragment stored in more volatile conditions could fall short of the confidence threshold, causing it to go uncounted, even if its content is just as genuine as counted fragments.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) Intentional exclusion isn't mentioned anywhere, the passage attributes this purely to storage conditions affecting readability, not deliberate omission.
- C) Familiarity with the text isn't discussed as a factor in whether something is counted or not.
- D) Language processing limitations are never mentioned in the passage as a reason for exclusion.

Q38: Which of the following best describes the tone of the passage?

- A) Enthusiastically celebratory
- B) Neutrally informative without any critical undertone
- C) Cautiously critical of the announcement's claims
- D) Dismissively mocking of the entire project

Correct Answer: C) Cautiously critical of the announcement's claims

Explanation: The passage repeatedly raises methodological concerns, such as unverifiable thresholds and withheld data, while acknowledging the technique's sophistication, showing a tone that questions the claims without outright dismissing them.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) The passage isn't celebratory at all, it consistently raises doubts and complications rather than praising the discovery.
- B) The passage is far from neutral, it repeatedly highlights problems and unresolved questions about the methodology.
- D) The tone isn't mocking or dismissive, it's measured and raises legitimate concerns rather than ridiculing the project.

Q39: Which of the following is/are correct as an inference from the passage?

- I. The conservators' unwillingness to share raw data limits independent verification of their claims.
- II. All recovered passages are equally reliable regardless of storage history.
- A) Only I
- B) Only II
- C) Both I and II
- D) Neither I nor II

Correct Answer: A) Only I

Explanation: The passage explicitly states that withheld spectral data prevents independent palaeographers from verifying consistency, supporting point I. Point II is contradicted by the passage, which says storage conditions directly affect whether a fragment clears the threshold.

Why the other options are wrong:

B) Point I is actually the one clearly supported, not point II, which is directly contradicted by the passage's discussion of storage variability.

C) Since point II is false according to the passage, including it makes this option incorrect.

D) This ignores point I, which is directly and clearly supported by the passage's statement about withheld data.

Q40: The word "vicissitudes" as used in the passage most nearly means

A) benefits

B) unpredictable changes or fluctuations

C) deliberate manipulations

D) permanent damages

Correct Answer: B) unpredictable changes or fluctuations

Explanation: "Vicissitudes" refers to unpredictable changes in circumstances, which fits the passage's point that a fragment's fate depended on the varying, uncontrollable conditions of its storage history.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) Benefits would imply something positive or advantageous, which doesn't fit the neutral to negative context of storage conditions affecting a fragment's countability.

C) Deliberate manipulation implies intentional action, but the passage frames this as accidental and circumstantial, not purposeful.

D) Permanent damage is too specific and negative, the word refers broadly to changing conditions, not necessarily damage at all.

Reading Comprehension 2:

A cohort of urban apiarists recently began documenting the resurgence of native pollinator populations within reclaimed industrial lots, spaces once dismissed as too contaminated to sustain meaningful biotic activity.

With mounting concern over residual heavy metals embedded in the soil from decades of manufacturing, there is a growing push to identify plant species capable of drawing these toxins upward through their root systems. Certain deep rooted grasses can, paradoxically, exacerbate contamination if planted prematurely, since disturbing compacted soil layers often mobilizes dormant pollutants that had previously remained inert. This phenomenon, termed phytotoxic mobilization, may account for the unexplained die offs observed during several early restoration attempts, wherein well intentioned interventions inadvertently worsened the very conditions they sought to remedy.

Sunflowers and mustard greens, by contrast, have proven adept at genuine remediation. Through phytoextraction, their roots draw heavy metals upward into stems and leaves, which are subsequently harvested and disposed of, physically removing toxins with each growing cycle rather than merely redistributing them. Their rapid growth and negligible cultivation cost

render them a pragmatic tool for reviving soil poisoned by generations of industrial use, provided the sequencing of planting is calibrated carefully against existing contamination depth.

Q41: According to the passage, why might early restoration attempts have caused unexplained die offs?

- A) Premature planting disturbed soil layers and released dormant pollutants
- B) The plants chosen were not native to the region
- C) Apiarists introduced pollinators too early in the process
- D) The heavy metals were too diluted to be extracted effectively

Correct Answer: A) Premature planting disturbed soil layers and released dormant pollutants

Explanation: The passage explains that certain grasses, if planted too soon, disturb compacted soil and mobilize pollutants that were previously inert, which is linked directly to the die offs mentioned.

Why the other options are wrong:

- B) Native versus non-native species is never discussed as a factor in the passage.
- C) Pollinator introduction timing isn't connected to the die offs, the passage focuses on soil disturbance from grasses instead.
- D) Dilution of heavy metals is never mentioned, the issue is about pollutants being released, not their concentration being too low.

Q42: The word "mobilization" as used in the passage most nearly means

- A) organizing troops for a campaign
- B) the gradual decay of soil nutrients
- C) the deliberate removal of contaminants
- D) the release or movement of something previously fixed

Correct Answer: D) the release or movement of something previously fixed

Explanation: In this context, "mobilization" refers to pollutants becoming active and moving through soil after being disturbed, rather than remaining trapped or inert as before.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) This is the literal military meaning of the word, which doesn't apply to the scientific context used in the passage.
- B) Nutrient decay isn't discussed anywhere, the passage is specifically about pollutants being released, not nutrients breaking down.
- C) Deliberate removal is the opposite of what's being described, mobilization here is an accidental, harmful release, not intentional extraction.

Q43: Which of the following best explains the difference between the deep rooted grasses and the sunflowers/mustard greens mentioned in the passage?

- A) Sunflowers are native, while grasses are an invasive species
- B) Grasses grow faster than sunflowers but are more expensive to cultivate
- C) Grasses can worsen contamination if mistimed, while sunflowers physically remove toxins through harvesting
- D) Grasses remove toxins permanently, while sunflowers only redistribute them

Correct Answer: C) Grasses can worsen contamination if mistimed, while sunflowers physically remove toxins through harvesting

Explanation: The passage draws a clear contrast, grasses risk releasing pollutants if planted at the wrong time, while sunflowers and mustard greens genuinely extract and remove toxins by being harvested afterward.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) Nothing in the passage discusses native versus invasive status for either plant type.
- B) Growth speed and cost comparisons between the two plant types aren't discussed at all in the passage.
- D) This reverses the passage's point entirely, it's the grasses that risk redistributing pollutants, not the sunflowers.

Q44: Based on the passage, what does "calibrated carefully against existing contamination depth" suggest about phytoextraction?

- A) It is primarily determined by weather patterns during planting season
- B) It only works in shallow soil with minimal contamination
- C) It requires no planning and works under any conditions
- D) Its success depends on timing and matching the method to specific site conditions

Correct Answer: D) Its success depends on timing and matching the method to specific site conditions

Explanation: The phrase implies that planting sequence needs to be planned thoughtfully based on how deep the contamination lies, showing that success isn't automatic but depends on careful, situation specific planning.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) Weather isn't mentioned anywhere in the passage as a determining factor for this process.
- B) The passage doesn't limit this method to shallow soil specifically, it discusses depth as a factor to consider, not a restriction.
- C) This contradicts the phrase directly, which emphasizes the need for careful calibration, not a lack of planning.

Q45: Which of the following is/are correct as an inference from the passage?

I. Restoration efforts can sometimes unintentionally worsen the problem they aim to solve.
II. Sunflowers and mustard greens are more reliable than grasses for soil remediation in this context.

- A) Neither I nor II
- B) Only II
- C) Only I
- D) Both I and II

Correct Answer: D) Both I and II

Explanation: The passage explicitly states that well intentioned interventions inadvertently worsened conditions, supporting point I, and it also frames sunflowers and mustard greens as effective through genuine removal, while grasses carry risk if mistimed, supporting point II as well.

Why the other options are wrong:

A) Both points are actually supported by the passage, so saying neither is correct contradicts the text.

B) This leaves out point I, which is directly stated through the mention of restoration attempts worsening conditions.

C) This leaves out point II, which is also clearly supported by the passage's contrast between the two plant remediation approaches.

Reading Comprehension 3:

When a decomposition timeline is presented in court as accurate to within a few hours, that precision can be more a matter of appearance than of evidence. A recent audit of decades-old forensic entomology case files has begun testing this assumption, asking whether the estimation models once used to convert insect colonization data into time-since-death intervals held up once temperate, real-world conditions were factored back in.

The trouble traces largely to how blowfly larvae development was measured in the first place: growth rates recorded under stable laboratory temperatures were routinely applied to crime scenes where temperatures swung unpredictably by the hour. Investigators call the resulting problem model overfitting; a paradox in which tightening an estimate to a narrower window doesn't make it more accurate, only more confident-sounding, because a single fixed growth curve cannot absorb the climatic swings a real body would have experienced. Several convictions are now being revisited precisely because decomposition timelines were reported with a level of exactitude the underlying temperature data never actually supported.

Accumulated degree hour calculations sidestep much of this problem, which is why they hold up better under cross-examination. Rather than averaging a day's temperature into one number, they track hourly readings taken at the actual recovery site, reconstructing the thermal history a given insect population would have lived through. A cold snap that stalled larval growth, for instance, no longer gets mistaken for a shorter time since death. The method also needs less laboratory-reared reference data to begin with. Though its courtroom value still hinges on one

condition: the reconstructed temperature record has to be checked, hour by hour, against verified readings from a nearby meteorological station.

Q46: According to the passage, why does narrowing a decomposition-timeline estimate to a smaller window *not* make it more reliable under the older models?

- A) Because a single fixed growth curve cannot account for the temperature variability an actual crime scene would have experienced
- B) Because laboratory conditions produce larvae that grow slower than those found in the wild
- C) Because courts require a minimum margin of error regardless of the data collected
- D) Because blowfly colonization only begins several hours after death occurs

Correct Answer: A) Because a single fixed growth curve cannot account for the temperature variability an actual crime scene would have experienced

Explanation: The passage explicitly states that tightening an estimate doesn't make it more accurate, only more confident-sounding, because a single growth curve cannot absorb the climatic swings a real body would have experienced.

Why the other options are wrong:

- B) The passage never compares the *speed* of lab versus wild larval growth, only how variably temperature affects it.
- C) No minimum court-mandated margin of error is mentioned anywhere in the passage.
- D) The onset timing of colonization is never discussed as a factor in the overfitting problem.

Q47: The word "exactitude" as used in the passage most nearly means

- A) speculation
- B) precision
- C) leniency
- D) consensus

Correct Answer: B) precision

Explanation: "Exactitude" refers to a level of precise correctness, matching the passage's point that timelines were reported with far greater exactitude than the underlying temperature data actually supported.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) Speculation implies guesswork, which is nearly the opposite of the confident precision the word conveys.
- C) Leniency relates to being forgiving or relaxed, which has no connection to measurement precision.
- D) Consensus implies agreement among people, not the accuracy of a measurement.

Q48: Based on the passage, how do accumulated degree hour calculations avoid misreading a cold snap as a shorter time-since-death interval?

- A) By excluding any case where temperature dropped below freezing
- B) By relying primarily on laboratory-reared reference specimens instead of field data
- C) By reconstructing the hour-by-hour thermal history actually experienced at the recovery site, capturing periods when development stalled
- D) By assuming a constant average temperature across the entire estimated interval

Correct Answer: C) By reconstructing the hour-by-hour thermal history actually experienced at the recovery site, capturing periods when development stalled

Explanation: The passage explains that tracking hourly site-specific readings reconstructs the actual thermal history an insect population experienced, so a cold snap that stalled growth is correctly identified rather than misread as less elapsed time.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) Excluding freezing-temperature cases is never mentioned as part of the method.
- B) This is the reverse of what the passage says. The method needs *less* dependence on lab-reared reference specimens, not more.
- D) Assuming one constant average temperature is closer to what the older, flawed models effectively did, not the accumulated degree hour approach.

Q49: Which of the following best captures the overall tone of the passage?

- A) Alarmed and accusatory toward forensic investigators
- B) Reassuring that all past convictions were soundly reasoned
- C) Purely descriptive, offering no evaluation of either method
- D) Measured and evaluative, favouring the newer method without dismissing the older one outright

Correct Answer: D) Measured and evaluative, favouring the newer method without dismissing the older one outright

Explanation: The passage calmly lays out a flaw in the older models, notes that some convictions are being revisited rather than declaring them wrong, and endorses accumulated degree hour calculations while still conditioning their courtroom value on external verification.

Why the other options are wrong:

- A) The passage raises concerns without blaming or condemning investigators personally.
- B) The passage does the opposite, casting doubt on some past convictions' reasoning.
- C) The passage clearly favours accumulated degree hour calculations over the older models, so it isn't purely neutral or descriptive.

Q50: Which of the following is/are correct as an inference from the passage?

- I. Some convictions may have relied on decomposition timelines that appeared more precise than the underlying data actually justified.
- II. Accumulated degree hour calculations eliminate any need for verification against external meteorological data.

- A) Only I
- B) Neither I nor II

- C) Only II
- D) Both I and II

Correct Answer: A) Only I

Explanation: The passage directly supports point I by noting that convictions are being revisited because timelines were reported with more exactitude than the data warranted. Point II is contradicted, since the passage states the method's courtroom value still hinges on checking the reconstructed record against verified meteorological station data.

Why the other options are wrong:

- B) This ignores point I, which is clearly and directly supported by the passage.
- C) Point II is false according to the passage — verification against external data is still required, not eliminated.
- D) Since point II is false, including it makes this option incorrect.